Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - October 22, 2026

Compiled summary for Thursday, October 22, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the October 18 interactive UI / UX record; verifying the United States Eastern date; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; extending case-study title cards with platform and device marks; adding a reusable, attributed white chip-component icon to the Prahl.dev desktop card; refining shared UI / UX controls, per-tip cutout masks, border rendering, and rotation timing; adding stack-specific interface copy and media; vertically aligning the active number tile with the triangle controls; preventing the active stack from fading during carousel movement; checking source and branch state; refreshing the project snapshot; and generating the October 22 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format: opening summary, source materials, baseline, goals, feature-grouped implementation details, committed-source sequence, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. The record documents completed source work and repository evidence, including limits on runtime verification.

Coverage begins after *portfolio_worklog_october18.pdf* and documentation commit **dd957f2**. Two source commits completed October 22: **6ef592e** and **1f7c666**. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 1f7c6661a2a7847cd61bdf9fc19a510c2c3c0a62. No deployment, Hostinger synchronization, public publish, external message, or additional source commit was performed during this worklog pass. The documentation deltas produced here are the refreshed project snapshot and this PDF.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: checked the system clock with `TZ=America/New_York`; it reported Thursday, October 22, 2026 at 11:00 PM EDT (UTC-04:00). This artifact therefore uses October 22, not the UTC date, which had already advanced to October 23.
- Project reader: ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio`. It refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` to 21,774 lines and 729,920 bytes with current source, assets, repository status, deployment notes, and PDF inventory.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 57 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDFs, from `portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf` through `portfolio_worklog_october18.pdf`. The archive contained 319 pages and 165,389 extracted words before this record.
- Archive comparison: compared naming and same-day Part suffixes, date treatment, summary density, section order, bullet voice, implementation grouping, Git and deployment disclosure, validation language, file inventories, follow-up notes, footers, and artifact closure across the full series.
- Nearest baselines: read October 18 in full and compared October 16, October 13, October 9, October 2, September 29 Part 2, representative earlier entries, and the July 11 first Portfolio record. October 18 remained the immediate source and design baseline.
- PDF conventions: confirmed the mature format as US Letter portrait (612 x 792 pt), PDF 1.4, unencrypted, black Helvetica / Helvetica-Bold text on white, compact margins, a dated first-page title, repeated dated footer, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex author / creator / producer metadata.
- Git evidence: reviewed both October 22 commit bodies and file statistics, the October 18 baseline, branch tracking, the aggregate source changes, and the refreshed snapshot. The two implementation commits are already present on main and origin/main.

Baseline Status Before October 22

- The October 18 baseline had the selectable UI and UX carousel, five key / lock variants, five-point star, active-tip masks, and joined discipline controls, but its landing-page case-study cards still used text platform labels and lacked a Prahl.dev desktop-component mark.
- The UI / UX selector and active number surface continued to need close adjustment around shared-cell framing, star cutouts, rotation timing, border continuity, and the number tile's apparent opacity and vertical alignment.
- A subsequent October 18–22 source commit had expanded stack-specific explanatory copy, added a detail-specific Alla Vostra screenshot, and adjusted stack 03 wrapping and the star's muted fill.

Goals for October 22

- Carry forward the accepted five-step carousel and star art while making the UI / UX controls read as one shared horizontal cell and keeping borders, masks, and active colors synchronized.
- Improve platform and device identification in the case-study cards, with crisp outline device marks and a reusable, white desktop icon whose reuse terms were recorded.
- Keep the number tile fully visible, align its center with the triangle controls, and prevent the active stack from fading while it moved.

Work Completed - UI / UX Philosophy Content and Selector

- Added explanatory microcopy to versions of stacks 01 through 04, preserving their matching content positions, sizing, alignment, and per-stack gradients.
- Added an Alla Vostra device screenshot to version 3 of stack 01 and refined its text-to-image spacing. Revised stack 03 copy wrapping and spacing across all three versions.
- Added a faint gradient fill to the rotating star tips while retaining the active-tip treatment. The selected star point continued to derive its color from the current numbered decision.
- Rebuilt the joined UI / UX button presentation as a shared three-position row: UI and UX retained their outer cell positions while the center cell became a shared visual opening for the active key or lock. The letter spacing was retained without inserting a visible space into “UI” or “UX.”
- Added five transparent PNG cutout assets, one for each star orientation, so the shared control surface could follow the star geometry rather than using a gap that exposed partial borders around the tip.
- Reworked the selector border as a continuous frame with rounded outer corners and top / bottom strokes. Its color continued to follow the active case tone; its surface and border treatment matched the active stack.
- Coordinated cutout-mask release with rotation timing. The selector mask released shortly before rotation, remained clear through the turn, and returned after the star’s animation-complete event.
- Kept the star, selector, active icon, number tile, and triangle controls in their existing layers while addressing reported border and mask interactions. The worklog records no changes to the star artwork itself.
- Corrected the active carousel stack’s opacity so its active state remained at full visibility as it moved. The triangle controls remained outside the animated stack and did not receive this opacity behavior.
- Moved the active number tile downward by 9 px to center it vertically against the triangle controls. The number tile’s opacity remained unchanged by this alignment adjustment.

Work Completed - Case-Study Cards and Reusable Marks

- Changed the featured-case-study section kicker to “What I’ve Made” and its section title to “Featured Case Studies.” Reworked the case-study eyebrows into deliberate short rows for Cinerific, Alla Vostra, Credit King, the in-progress project, and Prahl.dev.
- Added Android and Apple marks to the Cinerific title stack, and enabled platform brand marks in the featured Prahl.dev card. Existing device stacks gained reusable phone, tablet, and desktop mark options.
- Added the requested computer-chip figure to the Prahl.dev DESK slot, using its white treatment to match the adjacent device outlines. Added both the original and white SVG files plus an attribution record documenting the FreeIcons source.
- Preserved icon proportions within the mini-boxes and kept phone, tablet, and chip outlines distinct from platform logos. The new chip mark remained decorative and carried empty alternative text.

Work Completed - Rotation and Active-State Behavior

- Added a queued star-rotation schedule that released the selector cutout before the star turn, advanced queued actions in sequence, and restored the mask after the final rotation completed.
- Connected both the compact three-dimensional carousel and the alternate strip rendering to the star’s completion callback, while retaining reduced-motion behavior and existing staged navigation.
- Applied full opacity to the active stack so the central number tile no longer faded with the stack’s role transition. This corrected the parent-level opacity source; opacity on the star, mask, triangles, and number-tile fill was not changed.
- Kept the active number tile at its existing size and centered it with the triangle controls through a 9 px vertical offset. No triangle position or star mask was adjusted for that alignment.

Work Completed - Visual Refinement and Cache Recovery

- Adjusted the active/inactive discipline presentation through CSS-driven backgrounds and borders. The shared frame followed the current case tone, maintained rounded outer corners, and visually joined its straight border segments.
- Preserved the intended background visibility through the star cutout and kept the UI / UX text anchored in its original cells while making the shared center act like a cell without a visible box.
- Tuned the active key and lock presentation separately from the label frame, keeping their icon placement centered and retaining the existing outline assets and mask source geometry.
- Cleared the Next.js development cache when the local view continued to show stale output. The `.next/dev/cache` contents were removed; the running server repopulated some optimized image entries afterward.
- Recorded the remaining visual verification limit accurately: the requested source and PDF review were completed, but no fresh browser capture, build, or TypeScript check was run during this documentation pass.

Committed Source Sequence

- **6ef592e** - Updated UI / UX philosophy carousel content and visuals. Added explanatory microcopy to stacks 01–04, an Alla Vostra device screenshot for stack 01 version 3, stack 03 copy refinements, subtle star-tip gradients, and adjusted star visibility.
- **1f7c666** - Refined portfolio case-study cards and the UI / UX carousel. Updated card titles and labels, added platform and device marks plus the attributed desktop chip asset, synchronized selector cutouts with star rotation, vertically aligned the number tile, and held the active stack at full opacity.
- At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolved to 1f7c6661a2a7847cd61bdf9fc19a510c2c3c0a62. Both source commits were already synchronized. No source commit or push was performed while generating this PDF.

Validation Summary

- Verified the Eastern date locally at UTC-04:00 and refreshed the project snapshot with the repository's standard reader.
- Extracted all 57 prior PDFs and reviewed the October 18 source baseline, October 16 and October 13 records, representative older records, and all October records to preserve archive conventions.
- Reviewed the October 22 commits, file list, source diffs, current branch refs, UI / UX selector markup, active-stack opacity rule, case-card icon rendering, and new asset attribution.
- `git diff --check` passed after the final source adjustment. No npm check, type-check, browser-route check, or production build was run during this documentation pass.
- No deployment, Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, public-site publish, or external communication was performed.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- `app/PortfolioSections.tsx` - featured-case-study headings, eyebrow rows, and brand-mark configuration.
- `app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx` - reusable Android, Apple, web, phone, tablet, and desktop marks in project title stacks.
- `app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx` - stack microcopy and media, selector-mask timing, rotation completion, and queued navigation.
- `app/page.tsx` - stack-specific content and supporting media changes recorded in commit 6ef592e.
- `app/globals.css` - selector frame, cutout assets, dynamic case-tone treatment, active opacity, icon placement, and number-to-triangle alignment.
- `public/images/uiux/uiux-label-cutout-0.png` through `uiux-label-cutout-4.png` - five orientation-specific label cutout masks.
- `public/images/freeicons-chip-component.svg`, `freeicons-chip-component-white.svg`, and `freeicons-chip-component.ATTRIBUTION.txt` - reusable component icon and source / attribution details.
- `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` - reader-generated snapshot, refreshed before this PDF was created.

Follow-Up Notes

- Keep the shared selector geometry tied to all five star orientations. If cutout alignment changes, inspect every PNG mask against the active star tip and the rounded frame at the same viewport size.
- Preserve the active stack's full opacity while its position animates; avoid reintroducing an opacity transition on that parent, since child number-box opacity cannot override parent compositing.
- Keep the number tile vertically centered against the triangle controls when adjusting the desktop track. The present 9 px offset was tuned to the supplied screenshot and should be reviewed if the stack's scale or the viewport changes.
- Keep future case-card platform and device marks distinct. Maintain the FreeIcons attribution alongside the chip SVGs if the icon is redistributed or replaced.
- Continue to distinguish visual inspection from source verification: user-visible browser checks are still needed for selector-border continuity during all star rotations and for the active number's non-fading state.

Output Artifact

- Generated `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october22.pdf` using the established lowercase-month, unpadded-day naming convention. No Part suffix was needed because no earlier October 22 root-level Portfolio worklog existed.
- The title and filename use Thursday, October 22, 2026 after the explicit America/New_York time check at 11:00 PM EDT (UTC-04:00).
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, black Helvetica-family text on white, compact technical bullets, repeated dated footers, page numbers, and Codex document metadata.
- The source baseline was synchronized commit 1f7c6661a2a7847cd61bdf9fc19a510c2c3c0a62. The only repository-local documentation outputs from this generation pass are the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` and this PDF.